CHANNEL 4 PARTNERSHIPS

CARIA
User Guide

Everything you need to create, manage, and send Copy Rotation Instructions for UK television advertising.

~95%
UK TV SPOT REVENUE

3
STEP WORKFLOW

30hr
BROADCAST CLOCK

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OVERVIEW

01

What is CARIA?

CARIA (Campaign Approvals Rotation Instructions Attribution) is the platform where agencies and sales houses create Copy Rotation Instructions — telling traffic departments exactly which creatives should air in which spots.

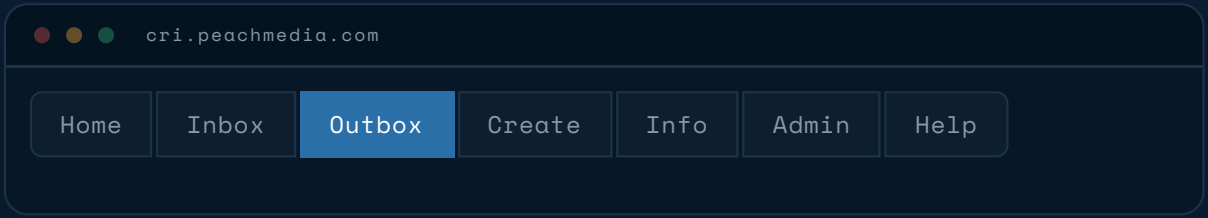
PLATFORM	cri.peachmedia.com
LOGIN	Browser-autofilled credentials
OPERATED BY	Optimad / Peach / Cape
DATE FORMAT	DD.MM.YYYY (European)

NAVIGATION

02

Finding your way around

CARIA has four key areas. You'll spend most of your time in the Outbox and the CRI editor.



Inbox

Received bookings from media agencies. Filter by Linear TV/VOD, search by booking ID. Select a booking and click "Create CRI" to start.

Outbox

All your CRIs live here. Filter by client, product, month, or status. Click a row to reveal Edit and View/Send buttons.

Create

Start a new CRI from scratch (without a booking). Enter client, product, campaign dates, and clock numbers manually.

Home

Dashboard with quick links to View Inbox and recent activity. Your starting point after logging in.

PROCESS

The 3-step workflow

Every CRI follows the same three steps — from metadata to detail blocks to sending.

01

Edit Copy

Add clock numbers, set campaign dates, fill in client/product details, and define mandatory fields like copy status and delivery info.

02

Copy Relationships

Create detail blocks that tell traffic exactly which creative runs on which stations, dates, and time bands. This is the most complex step.

03

Review & Send

Preview the CRI, check for clashes, tick the traffic department checkboxes, and send. Always send to both Channel 4 Traffic and C4 Streaming.

Creating a CRI

There are two ways to create a CRI — from a media booking or from scratch.

From a Booking

Go to the **Inbox**, locate your booking (filter on Linear TV/VOD or search by booking ID). Click on the booking, tick the checkbox, and press **"Create CRI"**. Most fields auto-populate from the booking data.

Can't find a booking? Use the "Request Product Link" button in the Inbox.

From Scratch

Click **"Create"** from the nav bar. Media type defaults to Linear TV/VOD. Enter the client name, product name, campaign dates, and first transmission month. Then add clock numbers manually or from the copy library.

STEP 1

S1

Edit Copy

Define CRI metadata and add your clock numbers. This is where you set the foundation for everything else.

Mandatory Fields

PRODUCT	Campaign product name
CRI DATES	From/To in DD.MM.YYYY
1ST TX MONTH	First transmission month
COPY TITLE	Creative name per clock
COPY STATUS	"Due" or "Held"
DELIVERY	Company + approx date

Clock Number Format

`REC/KKSB134/020`

REC	Prefix (usually "REC")
KKSB	Brand/product code
134	Creative variant ID
020	Duration/spot ID (20s)

In CARIA, clock numbers are split across 5 input boxes: `REC / KK / SB / 134 / 020`

STEP 2

S2

Copy Relationships

Build detail blocks — the core of every CRI. Each block tells traffic which creative runs on which stations, when, and how often.

Step 2 – Detail Blocks

DETAIL 1 Edit Delete

STATIONS	DATE RANGE	TIME BAND	CLOCK
C4-NETWORK	27.03 — 31.05	06:00 — 29:59	REC/KKSB134/020

DETAIL 2 Edit Delete

STATIONS	DATE RANGE	TIME BAND	CLOCK
Owned + C4 Streaming	27.03 — 30.03	22:00 — 22:29	REC/KKSB134/020

+ Insert detail block

Detail block anatomy

Each detail block can carry a combination of the following fields. Hidden fields must be revealed via "Show more / less detail".

Stations

Which station group to target. Click "Select stations" to choose from C4-NETWORK, Owned, Partners, or C4 Streaming. Use "Add stations from Detail N" to copy from another block.

Date Range

Hidden by default. Click "Show more / less detail" then select "Date Range" to reveal. Enter From and To dates in DD.MM.YYYY. Use "Copy dates down" for multiple clocks.

Time Band

Hidden by default. Reveal via "Show more / less detail" then "Time Band". Defaults to full day (06:00–29:59). For cherry pick, narrow to the specific hour or 30-minute window.

Clock Numbers

Add via "Add copy —>>" dropdown. Check boxes and click "Add". The Add button only appears on empty blocks — always add all clocks to a fresh block at once.

Important: "Show more / less detail" resets after each selection. Reveal Date Range first, set dates, then reveal Time Band separately.

How creatives rotate

R

Ratio

Multiple creatives share slots with a defined split. Add all clocks to one block, set ratio numbers (e.g. 1:1 for equal, 2:1 for weighted). Ratios must be whole numbers, max 10.

S

Sequence

Creatives play in a specific order, then repeat. Add clocks to one block, assign sequence positions (1, 2, 3...). Traffic plays them in that fixed order.

C

Cherry Pick

Specific creatives assigned to specific spots — no randomness. Requires individual detail blocks per unique date/station/time combination. The most complex type.

ADVANCED

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Cherry Pick campaigns

The most labour-intensive rotation type. You'll receive a schedule with exact spot assignments and must create detail blocks for each one.

1. Parse the rotation data

Extract each spot: date, station/sales house, time, creative name, and clock number.

2. Map to station groups

Map sales house codes to CARIA groups. Codes like ABC1WO and AD1634 both map to "Owned".

3. Plan detail blocks

Group spots by: **date + station group + time band (hour)**. If two spots share the same group, merge into one block with both clocks at ratio 1:1.

4. Create blocks in CARIA

For each group: insert a new empty block, select stations, reveal date range and time band, add clocks, and save.

5. Check for clashes

CARIA flags red warnings if blocks overlap. Fix by merging duplicates or adjusting ranges.

6. Fix CRI dates & send

Verify the "To" date hasn't auto-narrowed in Step 1. Then send to both traffic departments.

CHERRY PICK — PRO TIP

30-minute window splitting

When two spots share the same hour but need different creatives, split the hour into two 30-minute windows.

Problem

Two spots at 22:27 and 22:42 on the same date and station, each needing a different clock. A 1:1 ratio means traffic can assign either randomly.

DETAIL 7 (WRONG)

TIME	CLOCKS
22:00 — 22:59	KKSB134 + KKSB136

Solution

Split into two blocks. Each clock is alone in its window — traffic has no choice but to assign correctly.

DETAIL 7

TIME	CLOCK
22:00 — 22:29	KKSB134

DETAIL 8

TIME	CLOCK
22:30 — 22:59	KKSB136

Channel 4 stations

When clicking "Select stations" in a detail block, you'll see these groups under the Channel 4 tree.

C4-NETWORK

Channel 4 main network. The flagship linear channel.

Owned

E4, E4 Extra, More4, Film4, 4Seven, and related channels.

Partners

Third-party partner channels carried by Channel 4 sales.

C4 Streaming

VOD / streaming inventory. Required for C4 Streaming Traffic Dept.

Important: To send to C4 Streaming Traffic Dept, you must select **both** "Owned" AND "C4 Streaming" on your detail blocks. Without "C4 Streaming" selected, the traffic department won't see any updates and its checkbox will be greyed out.

STEP 3

Review & Send

The final step. Preview your CRI, check for red clash warnings, then send to traffic.

HOW TO GET HERE	Save from Step 2 → Outbox → click row → "View / Send"
TRAFFIC DEPTS	Tick BOTH checkboxes before sending
RED WARNINGS	Clashing blocks must be fixed first

Don't click the Step 3 nav link directly from Step 2 — it can cause a 404. Always go via the Outbox.

CRI Navigation Bar

Edit CRI: CRI733886

1. edit copy >> 2. copy relationships >> 3. review / send

✗ DON'T CLICK

Clicking "3. review / send" from Step 2 causes a 404 error

Traffic Departments

- [x] Channel 4 Traffic Department — NOT SENT
- [x] C4 Streaming Traffic Dept — NOT SENT

Send CRI

The 30-hour broadcast clock

UK television uses a 30-hour clock. The broadcast day starts at 06:00 and runs to 29:59 (which is 05:59 the next calendar day).

Standard Times

`21:45` → Band `21:00 – 21:59`
`22:41` → Band `22:00 – 22:59`
`19:15` → Band `19:00 – 19:59`

After Midnight

`00:30` → `24:30` → Band `24:00 – 24:59`
`01:30` → `25:30` → Band `25:00 – 25:59`
`05:00` → `29:00` → Band `29:00 – 29:59`

CARIA time band fields default to `06:00 – 29:59` (whole broadcast day). For cherry pick campaigns, always narrow to the specific hour or 30-minute window.

REFERENCE

CRI statuses

Your CRIs will show different statuses in the Outbox as they move through the process.

Outbox

CRI REF	CLIENT	PRODUCT	STATUS
CRI733886	Nestle KitKat	KitKat Sharing Bar	SENT
CRI733862	Monzo	Brand	NOT SENT (1)
CRI733850	Samsung	Galaxy S26	ACCEPTED
CRI733841	Deliveroo	Spring Campaign	REJECTED

NOT SENT (N)	N traffic departments haven't received it yet
SENT	Sent to traffic, awaiting response
ACCEPTED	Traffic accepted the instructions
REJECTED	Traffic rejected — needs fixing and resending

WATCH OUT

Known gotchas

Real issues discovered through hands-on use. These will trip you up if you don't know about them.

CRI dates auto-narrow

Every save may shrink the CRI date range to match the narrowest range across your detail blocks.

Fix: Always check Step 1 and reset the "To" date after detail block changes. Do this last before sending.

"Add copy" button missing

The "Add" button inside "Add copy —>>" only appears when a block has zero clocks assigned.

Fix: Create a NEW empty block and add ALL clocks at once. Never try to add to an existing block.

Delete triggers confirm dialog

Clicking Delete pops up a browser confirmation that automation tools can't dismiss.

Fix: Warn the user before deleting that they'll need to click OK on the popup manually.

Time field corruption

Typing into time band fields can produce corrupted values like "22::0" instead of "22:00".

Fix: Use form_input (set value) rather than typing. Always verify time values after setting.

Step 3 nav link crashes

Clicking "3. review / send" from within Step 2 can cause a 404 or session crash.

Fix: Save from Step 2 → Outbox → click row → "View / Send". Never click Step 3 directly.

C4 Streaming checkbox greyed out

If detail blocks only have "Owned" stations, C4 Streaming Traffic Dept won't detect changes.

Fix: Add both "Owned" AND "C4 Streaming" station groups to enable sending to both traffic depts.

QUICK REFERENCE

Cheat sheet

QR

Before You Send — Checklist

✓ CRI DATES	Check the "To" date hasn't auto-narrowed
✓ STATIONS	Include "C4 Streaming" alongside "Owned"
✓ CLASHES	No red warnings on Step 2
✓ TRAFFIC	Both department checkboxes ticked
✓ TIMES	Verify all time band values are correct
✓ RATIOS	Correct ratios set for multi-clock blocks

Key Shortcuts

COPY DATES DOWN	Copies first row's dates to all rows
COPY TIMES DOWN	Copies first row's times to all rows
ADD FROM DETAIL N	Copies station selection from another block
DEFAULT VIEW	Resets all Outbox filters

Pro tip: For cherry pick campaigns, plan ALL your detail blocks before touching CARIA. Use a tool like Copilot or a spreadsheet to group spots by date + station + hour, identify merges and 30-minute splits, then execute in CARIA.